Well, we kept our heads down, but he kept moving in our direction and when he was just a few inches from our table, he began playing, “California, Here I Come.”

I reached into my pocket and got the $5 bill and handed it to him.

Well, I was now down to a dime and a penny. A couple of days later, we were in Ireland in the company of a young Irish guide when we passed a tombstone close to where, according to legend, St. Patrick had erected the first cross in Ireland. The tombstone was inscribed, “Remember me as you pass by, for as you are so once was I, but as I am you too will be, so be content to follow me.” The sentiment had proven too much for another Irishman who’d scratched on the stone beneath the inscription, “To follow you I am content, I wish I knew which way you went.”

The guide showed us a wishing well and suggested we might want to toss in a coin. I reached in my pocket, gave Nancy the dime, and I flipped the penny into the well.

After I got home, I liked to tell people what it was like to travel through Denmark, Belgium, France, Spain, Italy, England, and Ireland on $5.11.

As my second term began, my most important priority was welfare reform. Because of lax eligibility standards, the number of people in California receiving welfare checks had almost quadrupled between 1960 and 1970 to more than two million. With about ten percent of the population, the state had more than sixteen percent of the nation’s total welfare recipients; it had become a magnet for able-bodied people from around the country who preferred a handout to a job. During my first term, I appointed a special task force on welfare that concluded that even if we were able to pay off the deficit and solve the financial mess the state had fallen into during the Brown years, welfare expenditures were growing so fast that the state would be bankrupt again